

Aussie Primary Academy

Year 3 English – Writing: My Magical Garden (Descriptive)

I can: write a vivid description of an imaginary garden using similes and metaphors!

Name: _____

Date: _____

Page 1 – Learn & Practise

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Writer's Toolkit: Similes & Metaphors

A **simile** compares two things using "like" or "as" (e.g. "as brave as a lion").

A **metaphor** says one thing IS another to create a strong picture (e.g. "the classroom was a zoo").

Example: "The flowers glowed like tiny lanterns" (simile) "The garden was a rainbow explosion" (metaphor)

1 Vocabulary Bank — use these in your writing

glistening

towering

whisper

shimmering

enchanted

fluttering

golden

mysterious

fragrant

ancient

2 Warm-Up: Simile or Metaphor?

Read each sentence and write S (simile) or M (metaphor):

a) The trees stood like giant guards. (____)

b) The pond was a sheet of glass. (____)

c) Her laughter was as bright as sunshine. (____)

3 Write your own simile or metaphor

Finish this simile: The butterflies danced like _____.

Finish this metaphor: The old oak tree was a _____.

4 Planning Organiser

What is in your garden?

What colours and sounds?

What makes it magical?

Who or what lives there?

5 Now write your description of a magical garden! (at least 5 sentences)

My Writing Checklist

- ☐ I used good vocabulary
- ☐ I used correct punctuation
- ☐ I included metaphors
- ☐ I included similes
- ☐ My writing is clear and complete

High-Five Tips for Parents & Teachers

Sit in a real garden or park together and ask 'What does that remind you of?' — this builds fresh similes.
Encourage at least one sense beyond sight — smell, sound or touch — for richer description.
Praise one strong word choice before suggesting any fixes.
Read the sentence aloud together to check it 'sounds right'.
Avoid overused similes like 'as busy as a bee' — challenge for a fresh comparison instead.

✓ Sample Answer Guide

Warm-Up: a) S b) M c) S

Checklist: look for varied vocabulary, at least one simile/metaphor, sensory detail (sight, sound, smell), and correct punctuation.